LOGTUN GUIDES · COMMUNITY



IAMLOGTUN

Point & Role Systems That Don't Get Farmed

How to design points, XP, leaderboards, roles and allowlist rewards that pay real contributors, not bots, multi-accounts and "gm" spammers.

gm fam, LFG!! When allowlist?

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Three accounts, same words, two seconds apart. Zero points. Real contributors get reviewed, not counted.

by @iamlogtun

For founders · CMs · Mods

WELCOME

Start here

Every point system is a promise: "do this, get that". Farmers read that promise faster than your real community does.

01 **Why point systems get farmed**: the incentive math behind it

02 **The farming patterns**: what gaming looks like in a real server

03 **Design principles**: seven rules for a system that's hard to game

04 **The role ladder**: Observer to Core, earned by trust

05 **A sample points table**: what earns, what's capped, what earns nothing

06 **Anti-sybil checks**: tiered verification and pattern detection

07 **Red flags for mods**: a checklist, and how to act on it fairly

08 **Launch checklist & mistakes to avoid**

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Who this is for

Founders, community managers and moderators running Discord or X communities with points, XP, leaderboards, roles (OG, Contributor, Ambassador), allowlist rewards or quest campaigns on Zealy- or Galxe-style platforms.

How to use this guide

- **Read Parts 1–3 first.** Once you see why systems get farmed, the fixes are obvious.
- **Copy the ladder in Part 4 and the table in Part 5**, then tune the numbers to your project.
- **Give Part 7 to every mod** before your first campaign goes live.
- **Run Part 8 before launch**, and again before any reward snapshot.

The one idea

Reward **outcomes**, not **activity**. Activity is cheap to fake. Outcomes (a solved problem, a found bug, a new member who stays) are expensive to fake.

PART 1

Why point systems get farmed

Farmers aren't breaking your rules. They're following them better than anyone else.

A point system turns behaviour into a number, and that number into a reward. The moment the reward is worth more than the effort to fake the behaviour, someone will fake it. Usually at scale.

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If value of the reward > cost of faking the action, the action will be farmed.
```

So you have two levers: make rewards less attractive to fake (delay them, review them, tie them to trust) or make actions more expensive to fake (proof, review, verification). Good systems pull both.

Six reasons systems get farmed

01 · YOU COUNT ACTIVITY

Messages, reactions, joins

Anything a script can do in a loop is something a farmer will do in a loop. Message counts reward the loudest, not the most useful.

02 · RULES ARE PREDICTABLE

The exact formula is public

If everyone knows "1 message = 1 XP, 50 XP = role", the cheapest path to the role is obvious. Farmers optimise the formula; real members just show up.

03 · REWARDS ARE INSTANT

Do it now, get paid now

Instant rewards mean an account can farm, cash out and leave before anyone looks. A delay gives mods time to catch patterns.

04 · ONE PERSON, MANY ACCOUNTS

No identity cost

If a new account costs nothing to make, one farmer can be fifty "members". Every reward you give per account is multiplied.

05 · THE PRIZE IS TOO BIG

Allowlist or token at the top

When a leaderboard spot can turn into money, you're no longer running a community game. You're running a bounty, and bounty hunters will show up.

06 · NOBODY IS LOOKING

Automation without review

Bots and quest platforms make scoring easy. But if no human ever checks the top of the leaderboard, the top fills with farmers.

What farming costs you

Farmed systems don't just waste rewards. Real members watch spammers outrank them, decide the game is rigged and go quiet. Your "engagement" goes up while your actual community shrinks.

PART 2

The farming patterns

Know what gaming looks like, so your mods spot it in minutes, not after the snapshot.

PATTERN 01

Low-effort spam for XP

"gm", "LFG", "wen" and one-word replies, posted all day to pump message-based XP.

TELL · High message count, almost no replies from others, nothing anyone would miss.

PATTERN 02

Multi-accounts (sybils)

One person runs many accounts to claim many rewards, often with similar names, avatars or join times.

TELL · Same wallet funding source, same phrasing, accounts that never talk to each other.

PATTERN 03

Bot messages

Scripts or AI tools posting on a timer, replying to keywords or pasting generic "great project" comments.

TELL · Regular timing, active 24 hours a day, replies that ignore the actual conversation.

PATTERN 04

Engagement pods

Groups that agree to like, reply to and repost each other's posts to win X-based quests or "top engager" spots.

TELL · The same small circle engaging within minutes, every time, on every post.

PATTERN 05

Reaction farming

Reacting to every message, or swapping reactions, when reactions earn points or count toward "helpful" scores.

TELL · Reactions on dozens of messages within seconds, including ones nobody could have read.

PATTERN 06

Invite farming

Inviting alts, bought accounts or uninterested people to hit referral targets.

TELL · Invitees who join, verify, never speak and leave after the reward lands.

PATTERN 07

Copy-paste "content"

Threads, memes or art lifted from others, lightly edited or run through AI, then submitted for content points.

TELL · Generic wording, wrong project details, the same text found elsewhere.

PATTERN 08

Quest-task farming

Follow, like, repost, join, then unfollow or delete once points land, often across many accounts.

TELL · Fresh X accounts, no posts of their own, follows dropping after each campaign ends.

One pattern is not proof

New members are often quiet, excited people say "gm", and friends really do support each other's posts. Look for **several tells together**, then review. Part 7 shows how to act fairly.

PART 3

Design principles

Seven rules. You don't need all of them on day one, but every one you skip is a door farmers can walk through.

1 Reward outcomes, not activity

Score what moved the project forward: a question answered and confirmed, a bug reproduced, a guide others used, a member who stayed. Chatting is welcome, but it's not a job.

Instead of "+1 XP per message" **use** "+10 when a mod marks your answer as the solution".

2 Keep a human in the loop

Bots can count. Only people can judge value. Any points that lead to a real reward should pass through a short human review, even if it's one mod checking the top of the list.

Example: content points are "pending" until a reviewer scores them with a simple rubric.

3 Use caps, decay and diminishing returns

Cap how much any one action can earn per day or week. Make repeated actions earn less each time. Let old points count less on the leaderboard, so one big farming burst can't carry someone forever.

Example: first 3 solved answers a day earn full points, the next 3 earn half, after that zero.

4 Ask for proof of work

Make people submit something checkable: a link, a screenshot of a reproduced bug, a translated doc, a recording of the space they hosted. A proof field filters out most low-effort farmers by itself.

Example: "Submit your thread link + one line on what you learned writing it."

5 Make roles a ladder earned by trust

Roles shouldn't be bought with points alone. Points can make someone *eligible*; a mod or team member decides who moves up. Higher roles need time, history and a real contribution, not just volume.

Example: "Contributor" needs points **and** two reviewed contributions **and** a mod's approval.

PART 3 · CONTINUED

Design principles

6 Delay and vest rewards

Don't hand out the valuable thing the moment a target is hit. Hold it for a cooldown while the account stays in good standing. Farmers hate waiting; real members barely notice.

Example: an allowlist spot is "reserved" and confirmed only if the account is still active and clean at the snapshot.

7 Match verification to the reward

A cosmetic role needs a captcha. An allowlist spot needs more. A token allocation or Core role needs a person to look. Ask for more proof only where the reward is worth faking.

Example: see the three tiers in Part 6.

Public rules, private weights

Be open about **what** you reward and **why**. Keep the exact weights, caps and detection signals internal. Members should know "helpful answers and real contributions count most". They don't need the formula to the decimal.

✓ Say publicly

What counts, what doesn't, that points can be removed for abuse, and how to appeal.

✕ Keep internal

Exact caps, decay rates, review rubric scores and the signals you use to spot sybils.

Points are a tool, not the product

If the only reason people show up is the leaderboard, the community ends when the rewards do. Use points to **point attention** at useful work, then let recognition, access and responsibility do the rest.

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The farm test: before any rule goes live, ask "How would I farm this with ten accounts and a script?" If the answer is easy, add a cap, a proof step or a review first.
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PART 4

The role ladder

The Community Funnel, turned into roles. Each step is earned by trust, not bought with volume.

OBSERVER → PARTICIPANT → CONTRIBUTOR → CORE

Most people start by watching. Some start talking. A few start helping. A handful become the people who hold the community together. Your roles should mirror that path, and the gate between each step should get harder to fake.

OBSERVER Just arrived	**Get in:** pass the verification gate (captcha, accept rules). **Unlocks:** read channels, ask questions, join events. **Who decides:** automatic.
PARTICIPANT Shows up	**Get in:** a minimum account age, time in the server, and a few real conversations (not message count). **Unlocks:** quests, events with rewards, points start counting. **Who decides:** automatic, with mods able to remove it.
CONTRIBUTOR Helps others	**Get in:** enough reviewed points **plus** at least two approved contributions (answers, content, bug reports, translations). **Unlocks:** contributor channels, early previews, eligibility for allowlist or rewards. **Who decides:** a mod approves; points alone don't promote.
CORE Holds it together	**Get in:** a long, clean history as a Contributor, nominated by the team or other Core members. **Unlocks:** feedback with the team, helping run events, mod or ambassador paths. **Who decides:** the team, after a conversation.

Roles can go down as well as up

Write it in the rules: inactivity can move someone back a step, and abuse resets them to Observer. A ladder that only goes up turns old roles into trophies for people who left.

PART 5

A sample points table

The ratios matter more than the totals. Copy the shape, then tune the numbers to your project.

Action	Points	Cap / rule	Why it's hard to farm
Chat messages, "gm", reactions	0	NONE Free to do, worth nothing	Removes the main reason to spam
Like / follow / repost quest	1	Low cap per campaign	Too small to be worth many accounts
Event attendance	5	Once per event; must answer a live question or submit a takeaway	Joining and leaving doesn't count
Helpful answer, marked by a mod	10	Full points for the first 3 a day, then half, then 0	A human confirms it helped
Original thread, video or article	10–60	REVIEWED Scored with a rubric; pending until approved	Copy-paste and AI filler score low or zero
Translation or doc fix, accepted	30	Only when the team uses it	Value is checked, not claimed
Bug report, reproduced by the team	40	Duplicates earn 0	Needs real steps that work
Hosting a community call or space	50	REVIEWED Recording or notes required	Proof of work built in
Invite who stays	15	Paid only when the invitee reaches Participant and stays active for a set period	Alts and drive-by joins earn nothing
Copy-paste, AI spam or a sybil cluster	-all	RESET Points from that source removed; repeat = reset to Observer	Makes farming a loss, not a gamble

Three rules that make the table work

1. **Two point balances.** A **season** balance for the leaderboard that resets, and a **lifetime** record of reviewed contributions for roles. A farming burst can't buy a role, and old points can't hold the leaderboard forever.
2. **Pending before final.** Anything above a few points shows as pending until reviewed. Rewards use final points only.
3. **Leaderboard = shortlist, not winners.** The top of the board gets **reviewed** for rewards. It doesn't get rewards automatically.

All numbers here are examples, not a standard. Start small: it's easier to raise a reward than to take one back.

PART 6

Anti-sybil checks

You can't stop every alt. You can make each one cost more than it earns.

The five checks

ACCOUNT AGE

Old enough to be real

Set a minimum age for both the Discord and X accounts before points count. Use your platform's built-in verification level as the first filter.

CAPTCHA / VERIFICATION BOT

Stop scripts at the door

A captcha or verification bot on entry stops the cheapest bots. Add a rules-acceptance step so every member has read what gets points removed.

WALLET + SOCIAL LINKING

One person, one set of links

Link one wallet and one X account per member for reward eligibility. Flag wallets linked to several accounts, and wallets with no history beyond a recent funding.

MANUAL REVIEW

Humans check the top

Before any reward, a mod reviews every shortlisted account: history, real conversations, quality of submissions.

PATTERN DETECTION

Look at accounts in groups, not one by one

Sybils hide individually and show up together: same join day, similar names or avatars, identical wording, the same funding wallet, posting in turns, engaging only with each other. Sort your shortlist by join date and funding source and clusters often stand out.

Tiered verification: match the check to the reward

TIER 1 · LOW VALUE

Cosmetic roles, chat access

- Captcha on entry
- Rules acceptance
- Minimum account age

TIER 2 · MEDIUM VALUE

Quests, allowlist, perks

- Everything in Tier 1
- Wallet + X linked
- Time in server and real activity
- Cluster check before snapshot

TIER 3 · HIGH VALUE

Token rewards, Core roles

- Everything in Tier 2
- Manual review of full history
- Two reviewers agree
- A short call or chat with the team

Tools change fast, so pick by function: a captcha or verification bot, a token-gating or role-gating bot, a quest platform with sybil filters, and a proof-of-personhood or "humanity score" check for high-value rewards. Test any tool on a small campaign first.

PART 7

Red flags for mods

One flag means "look closer". Several flags together means "review before any reward".

- [ ] Many accounts joined on the same day with similar names or avatars
- [ ] The same message, word for word, from different accounts
- [ ] Posting on a perfect schedule, or active 24 hours a day
- [ ] Message history that's only "gm", "LFG" and one-word replies
- [ ] Only active in quest or reward channels, silent everywhere else
- [ ] Activity spikes right before a snapshot, then disappears
- [ ] Reactions on dozens of messages within seconds
- [ ] Several accounts linked to wallets funded from the same source
- [ ] Fresh X accounts with no posts of their own, only quest tasks
- [ ] Invitees who join, verify, never speak and leave
- [ ] Content with wrong project details or generic AI wording
- [ ] The same thread, meme or art found elsewhere
- [ ] A small group that always engages with each other first
- [ ] Repeated "when allowlist?" and "how do I get the role?" with no other questions
- [ ] Replies that ignore what the conversation is actually about
- [ ] Points that jump far faster than anyone else's, with nothing to show for them

How to act on it fairly

1. **Collect evidence first.** Screenshots, message links, join dates, wallet links. Write down which flags you saw.
2. **Don't accuse in public.** Zero the points or pause eligibility quietly while you review. Public call-outs start fights and teach farmers what you look for.
3. **Use two pairs of eyes** for anything that removes a valuable reward or bans someone.
4. **Give an appeal path.** A ticket or form where real members can explain. False positives happen, especially with new and quiet members.
5. **Log every decision** so the next mod applies the same standard.

Mods play by the same rules

Mods and team members should be off the public leaderboard, or reviewed by someone else. Nothing kills trust faster than a mod topping the board they police.

PART 8

Launch checklist

Run this before you turn points on, and again before any reward snapshot.

- [ ] Write down the 3–5 outcomes you actually want (not "engagement")
- [ ] Decide what earns zero, and say so in the rules
- [ ] Set caps and diminishing returns for every repeatable action
- [ ] Split season points (leaderboard) from lifetime record (roles)
- [ ] Add a proof field to every submission that earns real points
- [ ] Write a simple review rubric and pick who reviews
- [ ] Set verification tiers for each reward
- [ ] Write the role ladder: how to go up, and how you go down
- [ ] Publish short rules: what counts, removal for abuse, appeals
- [ ] Brief every mod on Part 7 and the appeal process
- [ ] Test with a small group before opening it to everyone
- [ ] Plan a cluster check and manual review before every snapshot

Mistakes to avoid

✕ Rewarding message count

You'll get messages. Lots of them. None you wanted.

✕ Paying for invites at join

Pay when the invitee stays and takes part, or don't pay at all.

✕ Auto-rewarding the top 100

The leaderboard is a shortlist for review, not a list of winners.

✕ Publishing the full formula

Explain what you value. Keep the weights and detection signals internal.

✕ Changing rules backwards

If you change scoring, apply it from now on and announce it. Retroactive changes feel like theft.

✕ Ignoring quiet contributors

The person fixing docs or answering at 3 AM may never top the board. Nominate them.

✕ Roles from points alone

Points make someone eligible. People decide who moves up.

✕ No appeal path

Without one, every false positive becomes a public complaint.

PART 9 · SCREENSHOT THIS

The one-page cheat sheet

REWARD
Outcomes, not activity

REVIEW
Humans check the top

DELAY
Vest the valuable stuff

WHAT EARNS

- Answers a mod marks as solved
- Reproduced bug reports
- Reviewed original content
- Invitees who stay and take part

WHAT EARNS NOTHING

- Message count, "gm", reactions
- Joins that never speak
- Copy-paste or AI filler
- Anything with no proof

THE LADDER

- Observer: verified, can read and ask
- Participant: shows up, points count
- Contributor: reviewed work + mod approval
- Core: long clean history + team call

ANTI-FARM SETTINGS

- Caps and diminishing returns
- Season points vs lifetime record
- Pending until reviewed
- Public rules, private weights

ANTI-SYBIL

- Account age + captcha on entry
- One wallet + one X per member
- Cluster check before snapshots
- Verification grows with the reward

ACTING FAIRLY

- Several flags, not one
- Evidence first, no public call-outs
- Two reviewers for big decisions
- Appeal path + decision log

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